



RED BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Preliminary Notice

Date of Incident:	1 st November 2022	Time of Incident:	01:30 hours
Directorate / Region:	IDD	Main Roads or Contractor:	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type:	Damage / Loss	EQSafe Incident Number:	28900
Actual Consequence:	Insignificant	Potential Consequence:	Moderate

Incident Short Description:	Service strike during excavation for drainage installation
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What Happened:

During an excavation for drainage installation, a service strike to a known redundant communications cable has occurred. The crew began excavation using a designated spotter; the crew exposed approximately 3-4m of cable.

The team has used the excavator to expose the next area assuming it would still be running on the same gradient, however the cable has then taken an accelerated increase in gradient. During this operation the crew have grazed and damaged the redundant cable.

The Safe Work Method Statement (SWMS) and Permit to Work (PTW) both stated only hand digging to be used to expose cable within 0.5m. The crew during initial investigation stated they did not do this.

Work was immediately stopped and the PTW revoked. A formal ICAM investigation has commenced. Once completed, the lessons learnt will be communicated/shared through a final Grey Banner Alert as soon as practicable.



This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk profile relating to **Service Strikes (Above and Below Ground)**.

Immediate Actions:

Please note that these are generic actions for all to consider in relation to this critical risk (and is not reflective of this specific incident):

- Ensure all workers have read and signed on to the SWMS and understand the PTW for the work activity
- Communicate the potential dangers associated with Service Strike and the importance of ensuring [critical controls](#) are in place before work commences

Distribution of Notice:	Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations